



Group B

Progress Presentation

HelpMate: Can Keep You Safe

SAFETY-FIRST

COMMUNITY

IN-APP CHAT

TASK EXCHANGE

Our Core Topic

We are developing a **game-inspired community mutual help platform** specifically designed for urban and new comers in Melbourne, fostering connection and support through shared exchange.

Team & Key Roles



Leo

Product Owner & Team Leader

Guiding vision and strategic direction.



Anita

Software Developer & Frontend Developer

Building features and ensuring quality assurance.



Tammy

Software Developer & User Research

Crafting code and understanding user needs.



Bella

Design Lead

Shaping user experience and interface development.

Initial concept

Problem

- Lack of local support networks
- Discomfort in asking strangers for help
- Weak sense of community connection

Initial Expectations

- Visibility of help
- Users are willing but unaware of how to engage

Initial Innovation Idea

- Map-based platform for requests and offers
- In- APP Chat & Transaction Checking



Findings

1. Social Barriers

Evidence: 10/11 participants feel uncomfortable asking strangers

“I feel awkward asking neighbours”

Need: Low-pressure way to request help

Insight → Social discomfort is the main barrier

2. Trust Issues

Evidence: 11/11 participants raised safety concerns

Concerns about strangers, scams, and reliability

Need: Strong trust and safety mechanisms

Insight → Trust is required before any interaction

3. Friend-first Gap

Evidence: All participants rely on friends first
10/11 experienced situations where friends were unavailable

Need: Alternative support beyond personal networks

Insight → Value lies in “when friends can’t help”

4. Inefficient Solutions

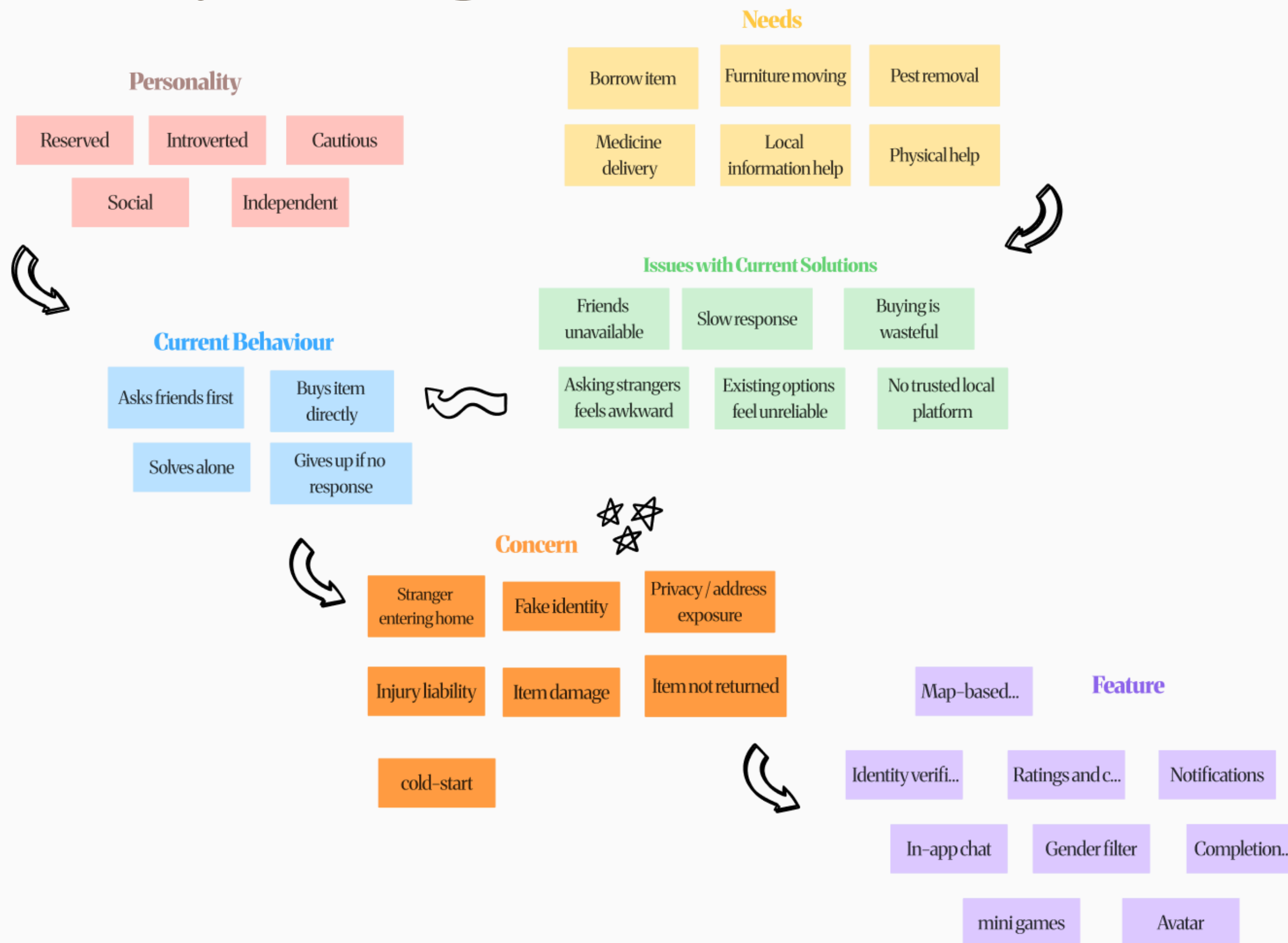
Evidence: Users buy items instead of borrowing

Some give up tasks due to lack of help

Need: Fast and reliable access to help

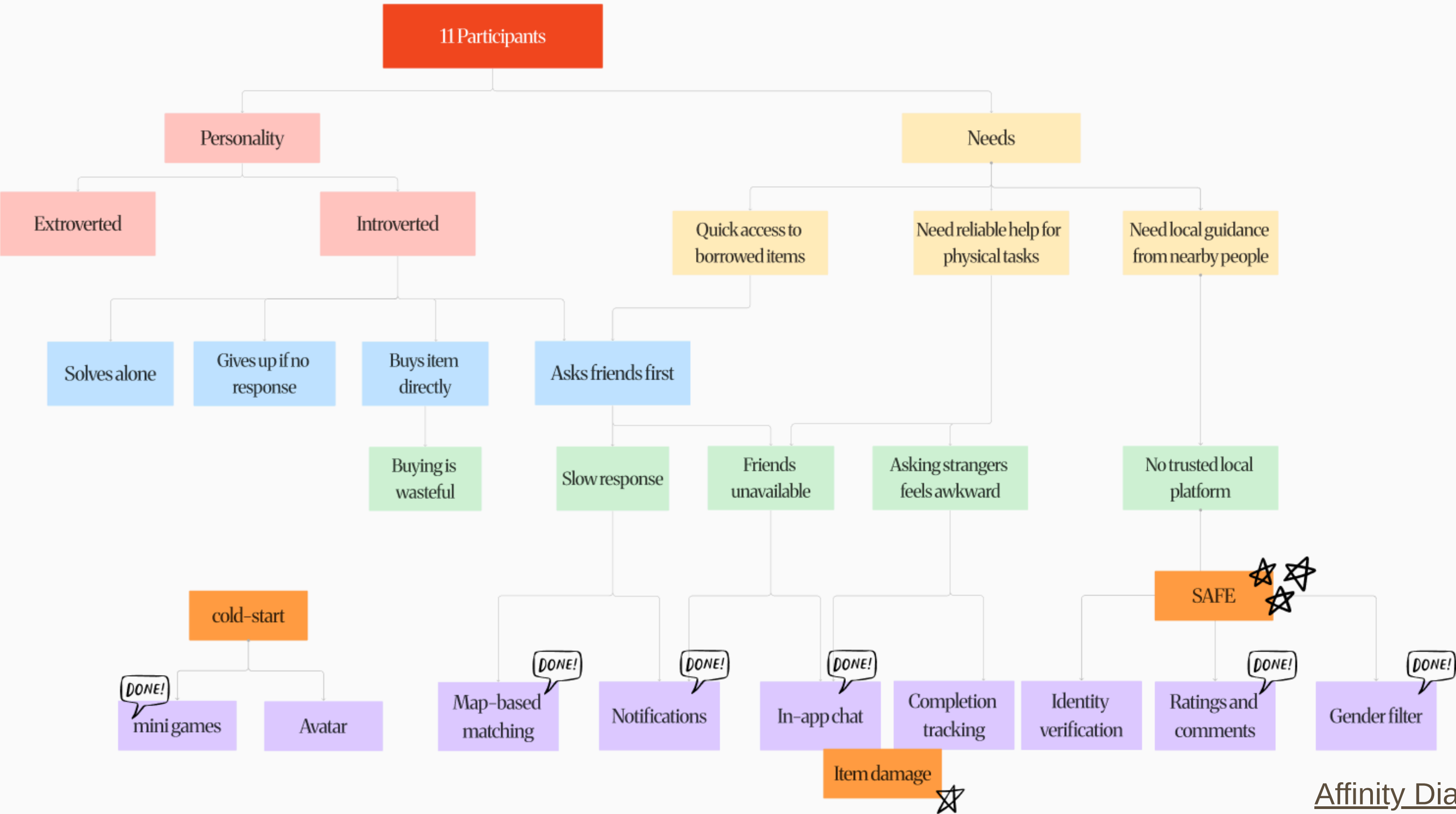
Insight → Inefficiency leads to wasted money and unmet needs

Affinity Diagram:



Affinity Diagram

Group mapping



Affinity Diagram

Persona & Scenario



Alex Chen → Pragmatist

28 | International Student (postgraduate)
Melbourne CBD | Live alone

Background:

Moved from Taiwan to Melbourne by himself. Has a stable professional life but no local network to call on. Relies on expensive services while some tasks could've been solved by neighbours

Scenario

Alex wants to mount a TV bracket on his wall. It needs four screws drilled into brick, which probably costs 10 minutes for a professional handyman.

He doesn't own a drill. Buying one for a single use feels wasteful and he doesn't have anyone living nearby to borrow. The closest hardware store is 15 minutes walk away. Calling a handman means a \$80 minimum callout fee.

He ended up leaving his TV on the floor for two weeks



Skylie → Community Seeker

25 | Working Holiday
South Yarra | Flat Share with 1 roommate

Background:

Originally from Hong Kong. Want to feel at home in her suburb. Most friends are in the CBD - inconvenient for a spontaneous hang out and instant assistance

Scenario

Late at night, Skylie spots a giant spider in the corner of her room. **She urgently needs someone to come to her place to remove that bug because her roommate is not at home and she doesn't have a pesticide either.** So, she posts on HelpMate app.

A neighbour living in the next building arrives in 5 minutes with pesticide. They end up chatting over some snacks for another hour. At the end, the spider is removed and she makes a new friend living in the same suburb for future hang out.



User Goals



Top Use Cases



Pain Points

1. Cut the cost of hiring professionals for minor tasks
2. Access tools and equipment without buying new ones
3. Build a reliable network for practical daily tasks



Borrow
Equipment



Physical
Help



Local
Know-How

1. Professionals too expensive for small jobs
2. No one nearby to ask for a favour
3. Self-sufficient by default, not by choice

“Why pay \$80 for a handyman when someone on my floor probably has the same drill sitting in their cupboard?”

1. Build real friendship in her neighbourhood
2. Experience Melbourne life as a local, not a tourist
3. Have someone nearby to call in for urgent need



Spontaneous
Hangout



Emergency
Help

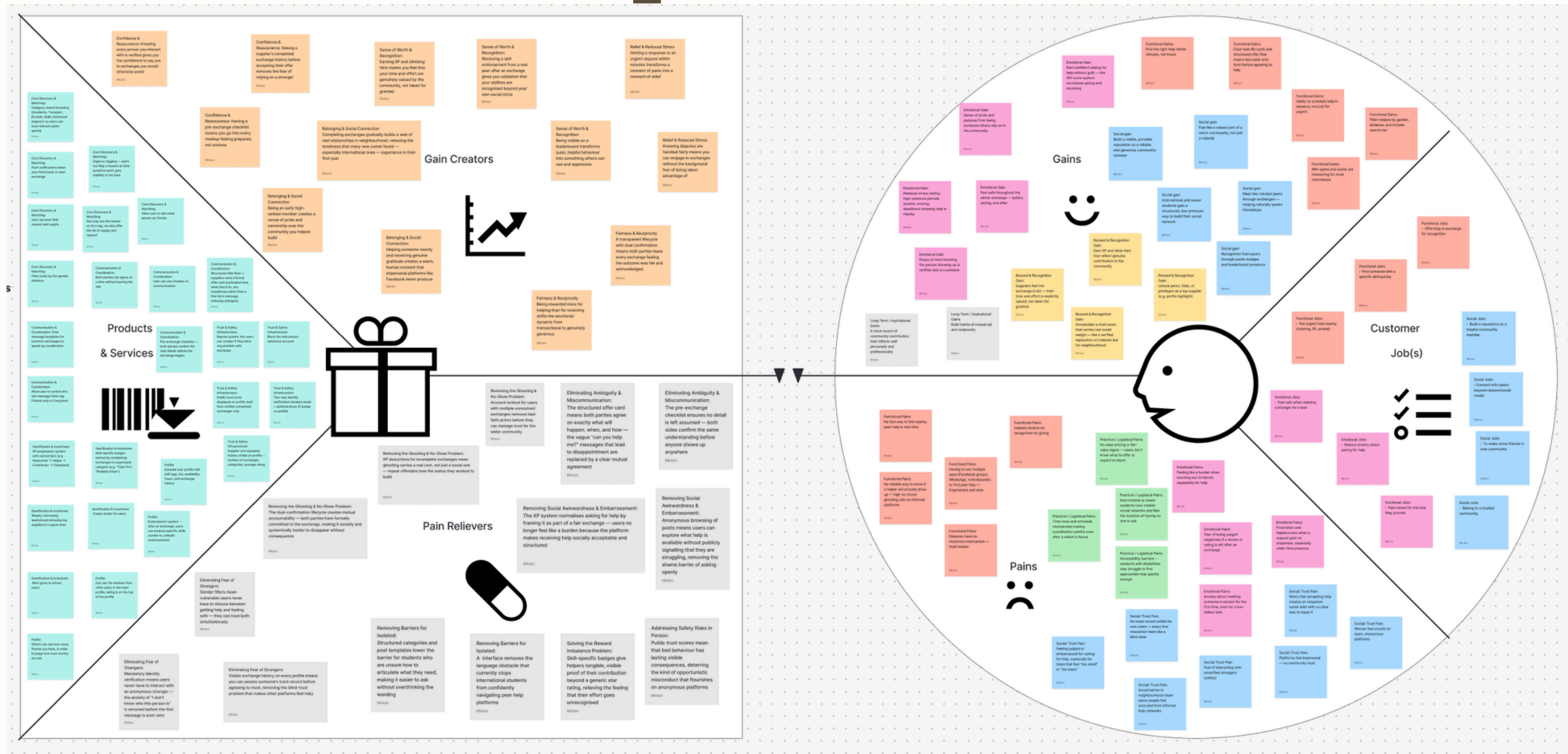


Local
Tips

1. CBD friends too far for spontaneous plans
2. Feels like a visitor in her own neighbourhood
3. No one nearby for an emergency
4. Want to have a smooth start for her working holiday

“I wish there is an application that allows me to make friends with people in the same neighbourhood, and also get instant help when I need.”

The Value Proposition Canvas:



Value Proposition

Innovation Hypotheses: (Example 1)

Our product development is guided by innovation hypotheses about how new features will solve user pain points and drive adoption.

Verified Identity + Privacy Controls

We expect our verified-identity system (student email/phone OTP) combined with gender filters and contact preferences **to provide** significantly enhance user safety and trust. **Because this** directly addresses the fear of interacting with unverified strangers.

Customer Job

- Functional jobs -> want to get help immediately

Pain

- Social/ Trust Pain -> Fear of interacting with strangers

Customer Gain

- Emotional Gain -> Feel safe throughout the whole exchange

Feature

- Trust & Safety Infrastructure -> Two-way identity verification

Pain Reliever

- Eliminating Fear of Strangers

Gain Creator

- Relief & Reduced Stress

Core Feature Requirements

Five “must-have” define our MVP, with one "could-have".

1

Real-Time Posts- (Functional)

Location-filtered, auto-refreshing feed and interactive map for instant discovery.

MUST HAVE

2

Verified Identity - (Ethical)

Student email or phone verification required before any post goes live.

MUST HAVE

3

Exchange Lifecycle - (Functional)

Stage tracking, dual confirmation, and a built-in dispute system for trust.

MUST HAVE

4

Privacy Controls - (Ethical)

Contact preferences, gender filters, blocking, and one-tap reporting.

MUST HAVE

5

Cross-Platform - (Environmental)

Full feature parity across iOS and Android from day one.

MUST HAVE

6

Avatar & Mini Game - (Functional)

Solves cold-start issues and adds an engaging, social layer to the experience.

COULD HAVE

Evaluate Ideas

Four KPIs :

- Complete Exchanges
- Respond Speed
- Supplier Return Rate
- Score and Review

Together they tell us if the marketplace is healthy and trusted.



KPIs are reviewed weekly and logged in-app for rapid iteration.

$\geq 60\%$

Task Completion
Rate: closed
exchanges $\div$ total
exchanges

≤ 15 min

Time-to-First-
Response during
active hours

$\geq 40\%$

Supplier Return Rate
within 14 days

4.5★ / Lv3

User rating and score
from in-app feedback

RISK #1

Safety in Real-World Interactions

Even with reminders and consent forms, we cannot fully predict what happens when two strangers meet offline.

→ Emergency Protocol

Users are prompted to contact professional help first in any urgent situation — the app is never a substitute for emergency services.

→ Clearer Interaction Guidelines

Added explicit boundaries, consent reminders, and do/don't rules directly into the exchange flow.

→ In-App Reporting

Any problem encountered during an exchange is recorded in-app for review and continuous safety improvements.



RISK #2

Verification: Plan vs. Reality

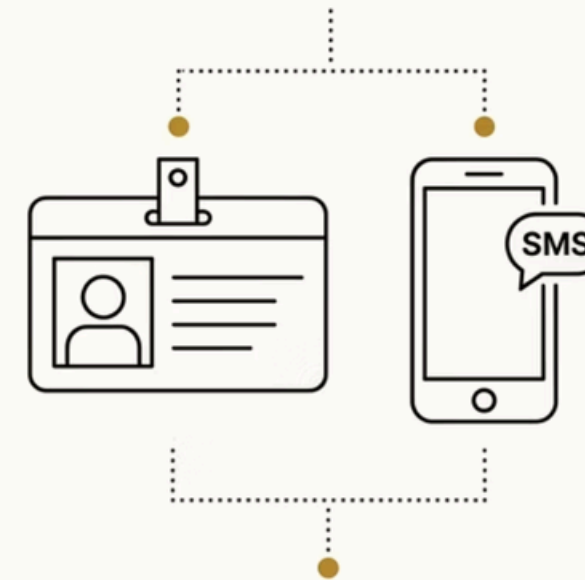
Our original verification plan hit two hard constraints:

- No access to university authentication systems and
- Real costs tied to SMS services.

=> We pivoted to a lighter but still reliable approach.

✓ Result: reduced cost and complexity while preserving our core trust guarantees.

Original Plan



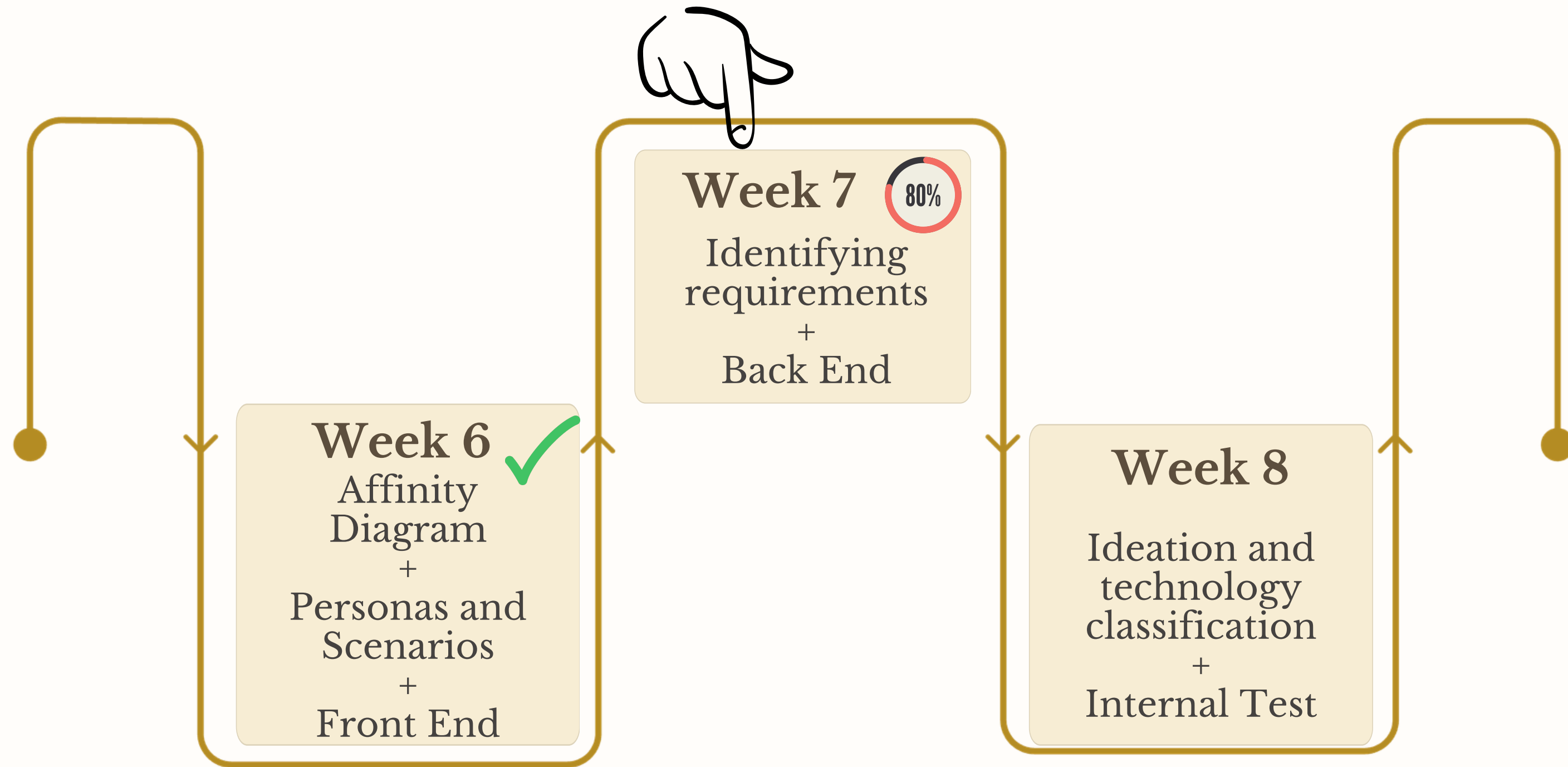
Student account verification and SMS phone verification. Blocked by lack of university authentication system access and high SMS cost.

Revised Plan



Strengthened login linked to Google account for double-check of user email. Lower cost, achievable today.

Timeline





QUALITY WORK